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A. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy and its supportive guidelines is to ensure safe and appropriate transfer of the patient with minimal risk. The aim is to clarify the clinical accountability of the nursing staff, medical team and supportive staff who are responsible for the patient's care to ensure that safe, appropriate transfer of patients does occur and their care continues with minimal interruption and risk.

B. Scope:

This policy is designed to gauze the requirements of patients who may need to be transferred from wards, departments, Emergency Room within the Hospital, to diagnostic facilities, to other hospital facilities.

C. Responsibility Person:

Consultant Doctors, Emergency Medical Officer, Ward Nurse, Ward Attendant

D. 1. Intra Hospital Transfer:

a) TRANSFER OF PATIENT FROM EMERGENCY TO OT

Such patients are very critical require immediate surgical intervention. These patients are accompanied to the OT by the nurse and the Emergency Medical Officer (incase the patient is in a serious condition).

b) TRANSFER OF UNSTABLE PATIENTS FROM EMERGENCY TO CARDIAC OBSERVATION WARD

Such patients are usually critical and hence require immediate care before shifting such patients, the cardiac ward incharge is informed who after confirming the availability of bed, gives the go ahead response, the patient is transferred accompanied by the nurse and the Chief

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Medical Officer, the patient is handed over to the cardiac ward incharge doctor and the Nurse incharge in the cardiac ward.

c) TRANSFER OF PATIENT FROM WARD TO CARDIAC OBSERVATION WARD

In case the patient's condition become critical in the ward and require cardiac observation, the cardiac observation ward incharge is informed by the medical officer on duty and availability of bed enquired. The patient is transferred from ward to the cardiac observation ward by the concerned ward nurse and the medical officer on duty.

d) TRANSFER OF PATIENT FROM WARD TO OT AND BACK TO WARD

Patients admitted in ward scheduled to go for surgery are transferred to the OT by the ward attendant, the patient is handed over to the OT nursing staff at the OT theatre complex.

Shifting of patient to war after surgery is done by OT attendant.

e) TRANSFER OF STABLE PATIENT FROM EMERGENCY TO WARD, WARD TO DIAGNOSTIC SERVICES etc

Transfer of stable patients is done by ward attendant of the concerned ward where the patient is admitted.

2. Inter Hospital/Diagnostic Transfer:

a.) **EMERGENCY WARD OR HOSPITAL INPATIENT WARDS TO DIAGNOSTIC CENTRES**

In case of diagnostic facilities are not available with the hospital, patients are transferred to such facilities for undergoing such diagnostic evaluations. The diagnostic centre where such facilities exists, are contacted by the consultants or by the medical officer (if instructed by the consulted) and an appointment fixed. Before sending the patient, the emergency department or the ambulance control room is informed which makes the necessary arrangements for ambulance and staff.In Case of critical patients a medical officer or nurse accompanies the patient to and fro from the Diagnostic Center otherwise the patient is accompanied by a hospital attendant.

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b) THE TRANSFER OF PATIENT TO OTHER HOSPITAL FOR PROCEDURES:

In case sudden procedures which are not available in the Hospital, the patient is transferred to such centers after taking consent and discussed the case and with his counterpart there and fixes the date and time for such procedure. The Medical Officer informs the Emergency Room to make necessary arrangement for Ambulance and staff before the patient is transferred, the Medical Officer reconfirms from the other hospital about the time of appointment and the patient is transferred accordingly, In case of critical patients a medical officer or nurse accompanies the patient. The patient is accompanied by the RMO (EMO). The nurse in-charge of the ambulance makes sure that all necessary emergency drugs and resuscitation equipment are available and functioning. After the procedure is over and when the condition is stable, the patient is transferred back to the hospital.

3. TRANSFER OF PATIENT TO ANOTHER HOSPITAL:

a) ***Non Availability of Required Medical Treatment***

In case the patient is to be transferred to the Government Medical College and Hospital etc due to non availability of medical Services of a particular specialty medical treatment, the on duty medical officer informs the patients relatives and makes necessary arrangement for ambulance and staff required for transferring the patients. Prior to the transfer of the patient the Medical Officer informs the other hospital/Medical college about the shifting of the patient to their facility. Case sheet containing information pertaining to the patient's complaint, diagnostic made and treatment given is prepared and given to the attendant accompanying the patient. Usually a nurse accompanies the patients to the other hospital, in case of critical patients , a medical officer along with a nurse accompanies the patient.

b) ***Transfer on Request***

In case patient or his relative decide to transfer the patient to another hospital for further treatment, the patient / relatives are explained about the condition of the patient and the risk involved in transferring the patient. Consent is taken and the patient is transferred to other hospital in the hospital's Ambulance or outside Ambulance as per the patient wish.

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If the patient condition is critical, the doctor accompanies the patient to another hospital and discharge on request summary is given to the patient .The nursing staff has to ensure that the patient is received by the hospital transferred to and adequate arrangement has been made for the admission of the patient in the transferred hospital.

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